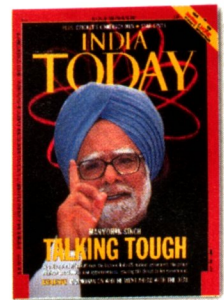


SIPRA DAS



"Talking Tough",
August 27, 2007

"Manmohan Singh has shown great courage by agreeing for a nuclear deal with the US. It goes on to show that he does not always depend on Sonia Gandhi."

PRAKASH MAHARANA, on e-mail

A Brave Front

The prime minister's resolve to face the nuclear deal crisis is somewhat similar to Mahatma Gandhi's principled stand against the British ("Talking Tough", August 27). One hopes he will stand firm in all such matters of national interest. A.S. SRINIVASAN, *Chennai*

The US has been known to create Frankensteins of nations and attacking them when they get out of its control. It would be better if Manmohan Singh forgot about the *havans* and thought more about undoing the damage this sell-out to the US (read: the nuclear deal) can lead to.

HEMENDRA A. MEHTA, *Mumbai*

You don't need rocket science to understand that a nation on the threshold of economic success needs stability. The nuclear deal will do just that and perhaps, come in the way

of Chinese supremacy in India. Is that why the Left is opposing it?

JINU MATHEW, on e-mail

Though the country is sharply divided on the issue of the Indo-US nuclear deal, the prime minister's outburst and his putting the CPI(M) in its place, has only enhanced his stature in the eyes of the masses.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

None of the members of the Congress has any answer to the questions raised by the Opposition and the Left. Since there are no real discussions in the Parliament, why is the taxpayers' hard-earned money being squandered in trying to run it. It is better to scrap such discussions and meetings.

M.M. KALE, on e-mail

Manmohan Singh has lost credibility by

surrendering all the options to gain America's confidence. Perhaps, in trying to woo the unipolar superpower, he forgot that the Indian political scenario is multipolar. PRAVEEN SINGH RATHORE, on e-mail

Misplaced Criticism

In his flight of fancy, Yashwant Sinha failed to explain a number of things ("Scrap the Accord", August 27). Would he care to tell us the reason for Vajpayee's panic, when after the nuclear tests of 1998, he volunteered a moratorium on all future tests in the wake of the US's adverse reaction? It is his initiative that has finally taken the form of the nuclear deal. Instead of being happy about it, why is the BJP playing petty politics? SHANTI BHUSHAN, *Noida*

Mental Blocks

Controversial authors like Taslima Nasreen get more

publicity due to acts of organisations like the MIM ("Playing the Faith Card", August 27). A country, where legislators blatantly violate the laws to "protect" the interests of the minority communities and where medieval attitudes still persist, can never be expected to become a world superpower. C. SUDHIR, *Chandigarh*

The attack on Nasreen shows that the Muslim world is not yet prepared to accept healthy criticism. Ironically, the secularists, who have never failed to place Hindus in the dock over their so-called outdated practices, have never bothered to target the negative forces operating in the Muslim community. ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

Organisations like Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (MIM) do not understand that by attacking Nasreen, they